

ELDA COMMAND

Experiential Leadership Development Activity

NZ Army Leadership Centre | Army Command School

ELDA is a leadership development activity, not a classroom course. Participants lead and follow as a team through a demanding activity, where behaviour is exposed under genuine physical, mental and interpersonal load. Profiling, peer feedback and mental-skills training convert that experience into a written plan for the unit.

AIM

To enhance leadership and maintain warrior ethos in order to provide world class, operationally focused leaders. This is achieved through completing a challenging activity supported by leadership tools and selected psychometrics, followed by reflection and behaviour selection to increase effectiveness.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

1 PERFORMANCE MINDSET

Develop the mental skills to perform under pressure.

2 THE ACTIVITY

Lead and follow through a genuinely challenging serial.

3 DEVELOPMENT PLAN

Leave with an actionable plan for the workplace.

HOW IT IS STRUCTURED: THE PERFORMANCE CYCLE

PREPARE

- Leadership Personality Report: a Five Factor profile covering day to day behaviour, behaviour under pressure, and personal drivers.
- Identify the behaviours that will help and hinder performance.
- Select the mental skills to be used during the activity.

PERFORM

- Execute the activity as a team under sustained physical and mental load.
- Apply the selected behaviours and mental skills in real time.
- Peers observe leadership behaviour continuously, in context.

RECOVER

- Structured self and peer feedback, written then delivered face to face.
- Systematic self-reflection on the hardest moments of the activity.
- Build the Leadership Development Plan and keep, stop, start Game Plan.

WHAT IS COVERED

Leadership fundamentals

Command, management and leadership as distinct functions. The four pillars of trust: competence, predictability, benevolence and integrity. Identity against reputation, and the four competency domains.

Leadership Personality Report

A validated Five Factor instrument reporting day to day behaviour, behaviour under pressure or with the guard down, and the needs and drivers behind it.

Self and peer feedback

Every participant gives and receives specific behavioural feedback on one development area and one strength, evidenced by what was observed during the activity.

Performance under pressure

Red head and blue head, performance as potential less interference, and a mental-skills set: noticing, grounding, tactical breathing, self-talk, visualisation, chunking and recovery habits.

Leadership Development Plan

Three development areas and three strengths, converted into keep, stop and start strategies that are effective, actionable and observable, then disclosed to the team.

WHAT A UNIT GETS BACK

- Leadership behaviour observed under real load rather than self-reported.
- Every participant returns with a written, observable development plan.
- Each leader holds peer evidence of how their behaviour actually lands.
- Nested in the NZDF Leadership Framework from Lead Self to Lead Organisation.

Next step. NZALC can scope a serial in New Zealand for 2027. Confirmation is required of participant numbers and rank range, preferred window, activity and terrain, staff and instructor support, psychometric licensing, and cost and logistic arrangements.